



KAMI

A card game with Mahjong roots

by Angelo Curatolo

A game for 2 or 4 players, ages 10 and up.

Short Game 30–40 minutes / Long Game 60–80 minutes

Inspired by Riichi Mahjong (Japanese Mahjong)

Kami 紙 means “paper” in Japanese

Kami, because this is a game in the Mahjong family played with cards instead of tiles.

This game was designed first and foremost as a 4-player game; the 2-player variant, as well as other variants, are found at the end of this rulebook. These rules may of course still be subject to changes and further tuning.

Feedback welcome: chroniqludiq@gmail.com

This ruleset was originally written in French by the designer. This English translation was produced with AI.

Acknowledgments

To my wife Brigitte, for her unwavering support.

To Kami's first playtesters: Micheline, Christine, Laure, Brigitte, Anne-Lise, Françoise, Christian, and Adam.

To all the players of the Wim-West-Country-Club in Wimereux.

To the proofreaders: Jonathan Taylor and Murat Briggs.

To Cléo and Zorro, for their steadfast indifference.

Layout and graphics created with the help of AI.

Goal of the Game

Be the first player to build a winning Hand of 11 cards from combinations, in order to steal as many Victory Points as possible from your opponents.

Kami The Components

3 Suits

Numbered cards from 1 to 9 in each of the three suits.



Hearts



Diamonds



Clubs



Honors

In each suit, there is one Jack (J) and one Queen (Q).



Jack (J)



Jack (J)



Jack (J)



Queen (Q)



Queen (Q)



Queen (Q)

10s and Kings excluded

The 10s and Kings are not used in Kami.



The deck is made up of 132 cards. Each card is present in 4 copies.

For scoring points

Mahjong sticks, poker chips, or any other equivalent materials can be used.



10 points



5 points



1 point



1/2 point



First Player token

Components

The cards

The Suits: ♥, ♦ and ♣, each consisting only of cards numbered 1 to 9 (the Ace counts as 1). Suit cards can be used to form Runs and Triplets.

The Honors: Jacks (J) and Queens (Q). Honors do not belong to any Suit, even though the symbols ♥, ♦ or ♣ appear on the cards — these symbols are used only to distinguish the different Jacks and Queens. Honors can only be used to form Triplets.

Important: in Kami, a Jack or Queen never comes after the 9 and can never be part of a Run.

Each card is present 4 times, for a total of 132 cards. Spades are therefore removed entirely, and among the remaining suits, all 10s and Kings are also removed.

You will need

- Four standard decks of playing cards, preferably Bridge-size, are needed to assemble this set of 132 cards.
- Tokens: four tokens worth 10, eight tokens worth 5, thirty-two tokens worth 1, and sixteen tokens worth ½. Mahjong sticks are ideal; poker chips work perfectly well too — or any other tokens you find suitable.
- One First Player token.

Setup

- All players shuffle the cards together, face down, in the middle of the table.
- Remove 10 cards face down from the shuffled cards. Set these ten cards aside, still face down, for now. They form the “Dead Leaf Pile.”
- Divide the remaining shuffled cards into 4 roughly equal face-down piles and place them in the center of the table in a cross. These four piles form the Forest.
- Each player has a personal discard pile in front of the Forest pile facing them.
- Place the “Dead Leaf Pile” at the center of the Forest. Turn its top card face up; it becomes the “Trump Indicator.”

The Forest and the Trump



The Forest, set up as a cross of four piles, with the Trump Indicator revealed at the center.

The Trump

The Trump is the card immediately above the Trump Indicator, in the same suit. If the Trump Indicator is the 6♥, the Trump will be the card directly above it — in this case the 7♥. And if the Trump Indicator is a 9♥, the Trump will be a 1♥.

For Honors, simply follow this suit order: ♥ → ♦ → ♣. So if the Trump Indicator is Q♥, the Trump will be Q♦. And if the Trump Indicator is J♣, the Trump will be J♥.

Scoring rule

Each Trump card in the Winning Hand is worth 1 extra point.

6♥

Indicator



7♥

Trump (+1pt per card)

First Player and Dealing

- Randomly determine a first player. This player receives the First Player token and becomes the player in first position. The player to their left becomes the player in second position, and so on.
- Starting with the player in first position, then continuing with positions 2, 3 and 4, each player draws 4 cards, one from each of the 4 piles, starting with the one in front of them and continuing clockwise. Repeat this a second time. To finish, each player draws two more cards: one from the pile in front of them, and one from the pile to their left. Each player ends up with ten cards in hand. Do not reveal these to the other players.
- Choose a “Combinations Sheet” (Casual, for Initiates, for Champions, or for Masters), and distribute the Starting Point Capital as indicated on the sheet. Each player places all their tokens to their left; this is the spot reserved for them until the end of the game.

You are now ready to play.

The Hand

As a prerequisite, a hand must always contain three 3-card elements and one 2-card element. These elements can be made up of either a Run of three cards or a Triplet, and finally a Pair. Each element must be made using cards of one single suit.

ex: 2♥3♥4♥ 3♣4♣5♣ 4♦4♦4♦ 6♣6♣

3♥ 4♥ 5♥ Run	7♣ 7♣ 7♣ Triplet	7♦ 8♦ 9♦ Run	Q♥ Q♥ Pair
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3 elements of 3 cards (Run or Triplet) + 1 Pair = 11 cards

The Key

In addition to this prerequisite, a hand must also contain a combination or "Key" (see the detailed list of combinations later in this rulebook). A few Hands are exceptions to this rule.

The Winning Hand

A **Winning Hand** consists of 10 cards in hand, completed by an 11th card, drawn or captured, to form 4 sets:

- 3 sets of 3 cards
- 1 set of 2 cards



Triplet	Sequence	3-Card Sets	Pair
A set of 3 cards can be a triplet . It consists of three identical cards.	A set of 3 cards can be a sequence . It consists of three consecutive cards in the same suit .	The 3 sets of 3 cards can be, at your choice, triplets or sequences .	The set of 2 cards must always be a pair . It consists of two identical cards.
		 or 	

Key points

- A **Winning Hand** consists of 10 cards in hand and an 11th card, drawn or captured.
- It is organized into 4 sets: 3 sets of 3 cards and 1 set of 2 cards.
- Each set of 3 cards can be a **triplet** or a **sequence**.
- The set of 2 cards must always be a **pair**.
- To win, a hand must also include at least one **Key**.

The Turn Jack

The Turn Jack is the Jack bearing the same symbol (♥, ♦ or ♣) as the Trump Indicator. Example: if the Trump Indicator is 6♥ or Q♥, the Turn Jack is J♥.

Exception — Jack as Trump Indicator: if the Trump Indicator is itself a Jack, there is no Turn Jack for that round. The indicated Jack therefore cannot be used to score a Favor as the Turn Jack.

The Position

A “Position” Triplet is determined by the player’s position at the table during the current round. For a player in Position 1, a Triplet of 1s. The same applies to Positions 2, 3 and 4. The suit does not matter; only the number counts.

Turn of Play

- On their turn, each player draws a card from the Forest, then discards a card face up onto their discard pile.
- Players play clockwise.
- Players start by drawing from the pile in front of the player in first position at the start of the round; once that pile is exhausted, they continue drawing from the next pile clockwise.
- Each card discarded by a player must remain visible in front of them. Discarded cards are overlapped to save space, in rows of six cards.

Personal discard pile

Each player keeps a visible discard pile in front of them. Cards may be overlapped in rows of six to save space.



Capture and the “I Take It!” Call

A card that has just been discarded by a player may be captured by another player only at the precise moment it is discarded. If the next player has already started their turn by drawing a card, it is too late. To capture a discarded card, simply call out “I take it!”

If several players call “I take it!”, priority goes first to a Triplet, then to a Run. Otherwise, priority goes to the player closest, clockwise, to the player who just discarded. A player capturing to complete their Hand and end the Round always has absolute priority.

Capture procedure

Triplet

To complete a Triplet, you may capture a card discarded by any player.

Run

To complete a Run, you may only capture a card discarded by the player to your right.

After the capture

In both cases, the capturing player calls “I take it!”, reveals the two cards from their hand that complete the element, adds the captured card, and places the whole (Triplet or Run) to their right. They must then discard a card from their hand. The player to their left then begins their turn directly — some players may therefore see their turn skipped.

Captures

A card can be captured at the moment it is discarded.

Capture to form a Triplet

A card can be captured by **any player** to form a triplet.

The diagram shows a player (you) capturing a 7 of Clubs from another player. The player's hand already has a 7 of Clubs and a 7 of Diamonds. After capturing the 7 of Clubs, they have a Triplet of 7s (7 of Clubs, 7 of Diamonds, 7 of Hearts).

Capture to form a Sequence

A card can be captured **only** from **the player on your right** to form a sequence.

The diagram shows a player (you) capturing a 5 of Hearts from the player on their right. The player's hand already has a 3 of Hearts and a 4 of Hearts. After capturing the 5 of Hearts, they have a Sequence of 3, 4, 5 of Hearts.

A card **cannot** be captured to form a **pair**, except if it **completes the winning hand**.

Open Hand, Waiting and Mirror

Open Hand

A player's hand is said to be “Open” as soon as

Closed Hand

A player's hand is said to be “Closed” as long as

they capture a card from an opponent and place the resulting element (Run or Triplet) on the table.	they have not placed an element on the table (Run or Triplet).
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Waiting

A Hand is said to be “Waiting” when it needs only one more card to become a complete 11-card Winning Hand.

Single Wait Only one card can complete the Hand.	Double Wait Two cards can complete the Hand. Example: with an incomplete 2♥3♥ element, either 1♥ or 4♥ can complete the Run — the Hand still needs only one card, but two cards can work.
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Being in the Mirror

A player is considered “in Mirror” when all the cards that could complete their Hand are already present in their own discard pile.

With a Single Wait, if the only card that can complete the Hand is present in the player’s discard pile, the player is in Mirror. With a Double Wait, the player is in Mirror only if both cards that could complete the Hand are present in their discard pile; if only one of the two is present, the Hand remains live thanks to the other card.

Consequence A player who is in Mirror is Out of Play and has a “Dead Hand.” They continue to play normally, but can no longer complete their Hand during that round. They must not reveal their Dead Hand status to the other players.
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YES — all awaited cards are in your own discard pile You are in Mirror. Dead Hand.	NO — at least one awaited card remains available Your Hand remains live.
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Kami Being in Mirror

A player is in **Mirror** when all the cards that can complete their hand are already present in their own discard pile.

SINGLE WAIT

In a **Single Wait**, if the only card that can complete the hand is present in your discard pile, the player is in Mirror.



In your own discard pile:



YES — all waiting card(s) are in your discard pile.

You are in Mirror. Dead hand.

DOUBLE WAIT

In a **Double Wait**, the player is in **Mirror** only if **both** cards that can complete the hand are present in their discard pile. If only one of the two is present, the hand remains live thanks to the other card.



In your own discard pile:



YES — all waiting card(s) are in your discard pile.

You are in Mirror. Dead hand.

DOUBLE WAIT

In a **Double Wait**, the player is in **Mirror** only if **both** cards that can complete the hand are present in their discard pile. If only one of the two is present, the hand remains live thanks to the other card.



In your own discard pile:



NO — at least one waiting card remains available.

Your hand remains live.

CONSEQUENCE

A player in **Mirror** is out of play and has a “**dead hand**”.
They continue to play normally, but cannot complete their hand during this round.
They must not reveal to the other players that they are in a dead hand.

The Kami

The “Kami” is a way of completing a hand by making a bet. When a player is “Waiting” — meaning they need only one more card to complete their hand — they may (it is not mandatory) declare a “Kami.” To do so, at the end of their turn, after discarding their card:

- They announce “Kami,” take a 1pt token from their reserve, and place it in front of them. This declaration requires a Closed Hand.
- On their following turns, they may only draw, hoping to draw their missing card, or hoping another player discards it.
- Several players may declare “Kami” during the same round.

Important rule and exception

Kami may be declared only if, at that moment, at least one of the cards that can complete the Hand is absent from all discard piles. With a Single Wait, the sole awaited card must therefore be absent from all discard piles. With a Multiple Wait, Kami remains allowed as long as at least one of the awaited cards appears in no discard pile.

Why Kami is enough

Since Kami is itself a Key, no other Key is required to declare Kami and complete a Winning Hand!

Waiting → Discard → Declare “Kami” + stake 1pt → Draw only until the end

THE KAMI

When your hand is in **Ready**, you may, at the end of your turn after discarding, declare a **Kami** and place a **1-point token** in front of you.
Several players can declare a **Kami** during the same round.

Setup to declare
1 point

Key :
2 points

When can you declare a Kami ?

A **Kami** can only be declared if, at that moment, at **least one** of the cards that can complete your hand is **not present** in any discard pile.

In a **Single Wait**, the only waiting card must therefore not be present in any discard pile.

In a **Double Wait**, the Kami remains allowed as long as **at least one** of the waiting cards **does not appear** in any discard pile.

Conditions

- ✓ Your hand is in **Ready**.
- ✓ Your hand must be **Closed** at that moment.
- ✓ **At least one** of the cards that can complete your hand is **not present** in any discard pile.
- ✓ Place a **1-point token** in front of you.

A Kami is itself a Key:
no other Key is required to complete a winning hand.

✓ Example – Single Wait

A Kami can be declared.

Your hand (10 cards)

Waiting card

The **J♣** is not present in any discard pile.
You can declare a Kami.

✓ Example – Double Wait

A Kami can be declared.

Your hand (10 cards)

Waiting cards

1♥ or 4♥

Discard piles (example)

The **1♥** is in a discard pile, but not the **4♥**.
At **least one** waiting card is not present in any discard pile: **you can declare a Kami.**

✗ Example – Kami not allowed

A Kami cannot be declared.

Your hand (10 cards)

Waiting cards

1♥ or 4♥

Discard piles (example)

Both the **1♥** and the **4♥** are already present in the discard piles.
All the waiting cards are in the discard piles: **you cannot declare a Kami.**

🏆 Result

✓

If you win the round
(**Thank You !** or **Served !**):
you score **2 points** for the Kami.

✗

If you do not win the round :
you lose **1 point**.

Completing Your Hand and Winning the Round

Victory by Draw — “Served!”

When a player is Waiting (missing only one card) and draws the 11th winning card, they announce “Served!” and reveal their hand. This ends the round and triggers a count of Victory Points followed by a payment of Points.

Victory by Capture — “Thank you!”

When a player is Waiting (missing only one card) and captures the 11th winning card discarded by any player, they announce “Thank you!” and reveal their hand. This ends the round and triggers a count of Victory Points followed by a payment of Points.

Clarification — Open Hand

A player with an Open Hand (having already made one or more captures during the round) retains the right to win by capture. As soon as they are only one card short of completing their 11-card hand, they may call “Thank you!” the moment an opponent discards the missing card. However, because their hand is Open, they are permanently barred from declaring Kami.

Payment of Points

After calculating the value of the winning Hand, the winner receives that number of Points from the other players.

SERVED! — Victory by Draw

The three other players share the payment as evenly as possible. Each player first pays the same amount, in increments of $\frac{1}{2}$ Point. If $\frac{1}{2}$ Point or 1 Point still remains to be paid, the remainder is paid in turn order, starting with the player to the winner’s left.

- **Hand worth 2 Points:** each player pays $\frac{1}{2}$ Point, then the player to the winner’s left pays the remaining $\frac{1}{2}$ Point.
- **Hand worth 1 Point:** the first two players to the winner’s left each pay $\frac{1}{2}$ Point. The third player pays nothing.

THANK YOU! — Victory by Capture

It is even simpler: the player who discarded the winning card pays the full amount of the Points alone.



Special Cases and End of Round

Special Cases

- +1pt for each Trump card present in the completed hand.
- In the case of “Kami”: if the player who declared “Kami” wins the round, they recover their staked point. If another player wins the round, that player wins the staked point. If no one wins

the round, the stake remains on the table and will be won by the player who wins the next round.

Under Trump

When a player succeeds with their “Kami” and wins the round, they reveal one “Under Indicator” card from the “Dead Leaf Pile.” The card immediately above it, in the same suit, becomes the “Under Trump” (same rule as the Trump). They add points for each Under Trump card present in their hand. Example: Trump Indicator = 6♥ (Trump = 7♥); on winning by Kami, the player reveals 3♣ as the Under Indicator — the Under Trump is therefore 4♣. Each 4♣ in hand = +1pt.

End of Round

- When a player wins the round by completing a Winning Hand with an 11th card.
- When a player draws the last card of the Forest without anyone completing their hand. In this case, each player reveals their hand. Players who are “Waiting” (missing only one card) share a 3pt bonus, paid by the players who are not Waiting:
- 1 player Waiting: the other 3 pay them 1pt.
- 2 players Waiting: each of the 2 non-Waiting players pays 1.5pt total, split equally between the Waiting players.
- 3 players Waiting: the remaining player pays them 1pt each.
- 4 players Waiting: no one pays.

Preparing the Next Round

Gather all the cards face down in the middle of the table and shuffle them all together. Remove 10 cards to form the Dead Leaf Pile. Rebuild the Forest and place the Dead Leaf Pile at its center, with the Trump Indicator revealed. Pass the First Player token to the player to the left of the current first player.

End of Game

- Half-Game or Short Game: when all players have been in First Position once.
- Full Game or Long Game: when all players have been in First Position twice.
- The Game also ends if a player has no points left at all at the end of a round, having exhausted all their points in a payment.

In all cases, the player with the most points in their reserve wins the game. In case of a tie, the players share the victory.

Combinations “Keys” and Points

The game offers four Combinations Sheets of increasing depth. Each higher version includes all combinations from the previous versions.

“Casual” Version — Starting Capital: 5 Points

Stacking rule

Each combination present in the winning hand earns a fixed number of points. These combinations can be stacked with one another. O/C: Open or Closed Hand. C: Closed Hand required. O: Open Hand required. All O/C combinations earn 1pt extra if achieved with a Closed Hand, with the exception of the Stream and the Favors.

Winning Draw — 1pt · Closed Hand required Draw the winning card.	The Favors — 1pt · Open or Closed Hand A Triplet of Queens / or a Triplet of the Turn Jack (same suit as the Trump) / or a Triplet of your Position. (All stack together.) No Bonus for Closed Hand.
The Stream — 1pt · Open or Closed Hand A hand made up only of cards from 2 to 8. No Bonus for Closed Hand. <i>ex: 2 ♠ 3 ♠ 4 ♠ 4 ♣ 5 ♣ 6 ♣ 5 ♠ 6 ♠ 7 ♠ 2 ♥ 2 ♥</i>	The Small Path — 1pt · Open or Closed Hand A Run in two identical copies. <i>ex: 1 ♥ 2 ♥ 3 ♥ 1 ♥ 2 ♥ 3 ♥ 4 ♠ 4 ♠ 4 ♠ J ♣ J ♣</i>
The Two Oaks — 1pt · Open or Closed Hand The same Triplet in two suits. <i>ex: 3 ♥ 3 ♥ 3 ♥ 3 ♣ 3 ♣ 3 ♣ 4 ♠ 4 ♠ 4 ♠ J ♣ J ♣</i>	The Kami — 2pts · Closed Hand required Declare “Kami” by staking 1pt (the hand must be Waiting). Kami may be declared only if, at that moment, at least one of the awaited cards is absent from all discard piles.
The Oak Grove — 2pts · Open Hand required Only Triplets. (Open Hand required.)	

+1pt per Trump card present in the hand. • +1pt per Under Trump card present in the hand — only on a Kami victory.

Examples — “Casual” Version

Example 1 — One combination

Hand: 2♥ 3♥ 4♥ / 4♣ 5♣ 6♣ / 5♦ 6♦ 7♦ / 2♥ 2♥ — Victory by Capture (“Thank you!”).
Combination: The Stream (only cards from 2 to 8) — 1pt. Total: 1 point.

Example 2 — Two combinations (with Kami)

Waiting hand: 3♥ 4♥ 5♥ / 6♣ 7♣ 8♣ / 8♦ 8♦ 8♦ / 9♦ (waiting on the second 9♦). The player stakes 1pt and declares “Kami” (Closed Hand), then draws the missing 9♦: “Served!”
Combinations: The Kami 2pts — Winning Draw 1pt. Total: 3 points (+ recovery of the 1pt stake).

Example 3 — Three combinations (with Kami)

Waiting hand: 1♥ 2♥ 3♥ / 1♥ 2♥ 3♥ / 4♦ 4♦ 4♦ / J♣ (waiting on the second J♣). Player in Position 1. They stake 1pt and declare “Kami”, then draw the missing J♣: “Served!”
Combinations: The Small Path (closed) 2pts — The Kami 2pts — Winning Draw 1pt. Total: 5 points (+ recovery of the 1pt stake).

Example 4 — With Trump

Same hand as Example 3, but the Trump Indicator = 3♦ → the Trump is 4♦. The hand contains three 4♦ (the Triplet). Combinations: The Small Path (closed) 2pts — The Kami 2pts — Winning Draw 1pt — Trump (3 cards) +3pts. Total: 8 points (+ recovery of the 1pt stake).

Combinations “Keys” and Points — “for Initiates” Version

Starting Capital: 10 Points ($8 \times 1\text{pt}$, $4 \times \frac{1}{2}\text{pt}$).

Stacking rule

Each combination present in the winning hand earns a fixed number of points. These combinations can be stacked with one another. O/C: Open or Closed Hand. C: Closed Hand required. O: Open Hand required. All O/C combinations earn 1pt extra if achieved with a Closed Hand, with the exception of the Stream and the Favors.

Winning Draw — 1pt · Closed Hand required [CASUAL] Draw the winning card.	The Favors — 1pt · Open or Closed Hand [CASUAL] A Triplet of Queens / or a Triplet of the Turn Jack (same suit as the Trump) / or a Triplet of your Position. (All stack together.) No Bonus for Closed Hand.
The Stream — 1pt · Open or Closed Hand [CASUAL] A hand made up only of cards from 2 to 8. No Bonus for Closed Hand. <i>ex: 2 ♠ 3 ♠ 4 ♠ 4 ♣ 5 ♣ 6 ♣ 5 ♠ 6 ♠ 7 ♠ 2 ♥ 2 ♥</i>	The Small Path — 1pt · Open or Closed Hand [CASUAL] A Run in two identical copies. <i>ex: 1 ♥ 2 ♥ 3 ♥ 1 ♥ 2 ♥ 3 ♥ 4 ♠ 4 ♠ 4 ♠ J ♣ J ♣</i>
The Two Oaks — 1pt · Open or Closed Hand [CASUAL] The same Triplet in two suits. <i>ex: 3 ♥ 3 ♥ 3 ♥ 3 ♣ 3 ♣ 3 ♣ 4 ♠ 4 ♠ 4 ♠ J ♣ J ♣</i>	The Kami — 2pts · Closed Hand required [CASUAL] Declare “Kami” by staking 1pt (the hand must be Waiting). Kami may be declared only if, at that moment, at least one of the awaited cards is absent from all discard piles.
The Oak Grove — 2pts · Open Hand required [CASUAL] Only Triplets. (Open Hand required.)	The River — 1pt · Closed Hand required [INITIATES] Runs only, double wait, ordinary pair. <i>ex: with 2 ♥ 3 ♥ in hand, either 1 ♥ or 4 ♥ can complete the Run</i>
The Two Maples — 2pts · Open or Closed Hand [INITIATES] Two Concealed Triplets (the rest of the hand may be open).	Left Bank Right Bank — 2pts · Open or Closed Hand [INITIATES] Every element of the hand contains Terminals or Honors. <i>ex: 1 ♥ 2 ♥ 3 ♥ 7 ♣ 8 ♣ 9 ♣ Q ♥ Q ♥ Q ♥ 9 ♣ 9 ♣</i>
The 5 Pairs — 3pts · Closed Hand required [INITIATES] 5 pairs + one card identical to a card in one of the Pairs. <i>ex: 1 ♥ 1 ♥ J ♣ J ♣ 5 ♣ 5 ♣ 9 ♠ 9 ♠ 6 ♥ 6 ♥ 5 ♣</i>	

+1pt per Trump card present in the hand. • +1pt per Under Trump card present in the hand — only on a Kami victory.

Examples — “for Initiates” Version

Example 1 — One combination

Hand: 1♥2♥3♥ / 7♣8♣9♣ / J♦J♦J♦ / 9♣9♣ — Victory by Capture (“Thank you!”).
Combination: Left Bank Right Bank — 2pts. Total: 2 points.

Example 2 — Two combinations (with Kami)

Waiting hand: 4♦5♦6♦ / 1♣2♣3♣ / 8♥8♥8♥ / 6♥ (waiting on the second 6♥). The player stakes 1pt and declares “Kami”, then draws the missing 6♥: “Served!”

Combinations: The Kami 2pts — Winning Draw 1pt. Total: 3 points (+ recovery of the 1pt stake).

Example 3 — Three combinations (with Kami)

Waiting hand: 2♥3♥4♥ / 5♦6♦7♦ / 7♣8♣ / 4♣4♣ (double wait: 6♣ or 9♣). The player stakes 1pt and declares “Kami”, then draws 9♣: “Served!” (completed hand: 7♣8♣9♣).

Combinations: The River 1pt — The Kami 2pts — Winning Draw 1pt. Total: 4 points (+ recovery of the 1pt stake).

Example 4 — With Trump

Same hand as Example 3, but the Trump Indicator = 1♥ → the Trump is 2♥. The hand contains one 2♥. Combinations: The River 1pt — The Kami 2pts — Winning Draw 1pt — Trump (1 card) +1pt. Total: 5 points (+ recovery of the 1pt stake).

Combinations “Keys” and Points — “for Champions” Version

Starting Capital: 15 Points (1 × 5pts, 8 × 1pt, 4 × ½ pt).

Stacking rule

Each combination present in the winning hand earns a fixed number of points. These combinations can be stacked with one another. O/C: Open or Closed Hand. C: Closed Hand required. O: Open Hand required. All O/C combinations earn 1pt extra if achieved with a Closed Hand, with the exception of the Stream and the Favors. Stacking exception: The Small Path and the Long Path never stack together.

Winning Draw — 1pt · Closed Hand required [CASUAL] Draw the winning card.	The Favors — 1pt · Open or Closed Hand [CASUAL] A Triplet of Queens / or a Triplet of the Turn Jack (same suit as the Trump) / or a Triplet of your Position. (All stack together.) No Bonus for Closed Hand.
The Stream — 1pt · Open or Closed Hand [CASUAL] A hand made up only of cards from 2 to 8. No Bonus for Closed Hand. <i>ex: 2 ♠ 3 ♠ 4 ♠ 4 ♣ 5 ♣ 6 ♣ 5 ♠ 6 ♠ 7 ♠ 2 ♠ 2 ♠</i>	The Small Path — 1pt · Open or Closed Hand [CASUAL] A Run in two identical copies. <i>ex: 1 ♥ 2 ♥ 3 ♥ 1 ♥ 2 ♥ 3 ♥ 4 ♠ 4 ♠ 4 ♠ J ♣ J ♣</i>
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The Oak Grove — 2pts · Open Hand required [CASUAL] Only Triplets. (Open Hand required.)	The River — 1pt · Closed Hand required [INITIATES] Runs only, double wait, ordinary pair. <i>ex: with 2 ♥ 3 ♥ in hand, either 1 ♥ or 4 ♥ can complete the Run</i>
The Two Maples — 2pts · Open or Closed Hand [INITIATES] Two Concealed Triplets (the rest of the hand may be open).	Left Bank Right Bank — 2pts · Open or Closed Hand [INITIATES] Every element of the hand contains Terminals or Honors. <i>ex: 1 ♥ 2 ♥ 3 ♥ 7 ♣ 8 ♣ 9 ♣ Q ♥ Q ♥ Q ♥ 9 ♣ 9 ♣</i>
The 5 Pairs — 3pts · Closed Hand required [INITIATES] 5 pairs + one card identical to a card in one of the Pairs. <i>ex: 1 ♥ 1 ♥ J ♣ J ♣ 5 ♣ 5 ♣ 9 ♠ 9 ♠ 6 ♥ 6 ♥ 5 ♣</i>	The Apples Pears — 2pts · Open or Closed Hand [CHAMPIONS] A single suit plus Honors. <i>ex: 1 ♥ 2 ♥ 3 ♥ 9 ♥ 9 ♥ 9 ♥ Q ♠ Q ♠ Q ♠ 8 ♥ 8 ♥</i>
The Prestige — 3pts · Open or Closed Hand [CHAMPIONS] Only Terminals or Honors. <i>ex: 1 ♠ 1 ♠ 1 ♠ 9 ♣ 9 ♣ 9 ♣ J ♠ J ♠ Q ♥ Q ♥</i>	The Winding Path — 3pts · Open or Closed Hand [CHAMPIONS] The same Run in three suits. <i>ex: 1 ♥ 2 ♥ 3 ♥ 1 ♣ 2 ♣ 3 ♣ 1 ♠ 2 ♠ 3 ♠ 4 ♣ 4 ♣</i>
The Long Path — 3pts · Open or Closed Hand [CHAMPIONS] A Run in two identical copies + the same Run in another suit.	The Great Road — 3pts · Open or Closed Hand [CHAMPIONS] 123456789 in a single suit + any pair.

ex: 1♥2♥3♥1♥2♥3♥1♣2♣3♣4♣4♣

Examples — “for Champions” Version

+1pt per Trump card present in the hand. • +1pt per Under Trump card present in the hand — only on a Kami victory.

Example 1 — One combination

Hand: 4♥5♥6♥ / 4♦5♦6♦ / 4♣5♣6♣ / 9♥9♥ — Victory by Capture (“Thank you!”).
Combination: The Winding Path (the same Run in all three suits) — 3pts. Total: 3 points.

Example 2 — Two combinations (with Kami)

Waiting hand: 2♣3♣4♣ / 5♦6♦7♦ / J♥J♥J♥ / 8♣ (waiting on the second 8♣). The player stakes 1pt and declares “Kami”, then draws the missing 8♣: “Served!”
Combinations: The Kami 2pts — Winning Draw 1pt. Total: 3 points (+ recovery of the 1pt stake).

Example 3 — Three combinations (with Kami)

Waiting hand: 3♦4♦5♦ / 6♦7♦8♦ / J♦J♦J♦ / Q♦ (waiting on the second Q♦). The player stakes 1pt and declares “Kami”, then draws the missing Q♦: “Served!”
Combinations: The Apples Pears (closed) 3pts — The Kami 2pts — Winning Draw 1pt. Total: 6 points (+ recovery of the 1pt stake).

Example 4 — With Trump

Same hand as Example 3, but the Trump Indicator = 2♦ → the Trump is 3♦, and the Trump suit is ♦ → the Turn Jack is J♦. The hand contains one 3♦ (Trump) and a Triplet of J♦ (therefore The Favors: Triplet of the Turn Jack). Combinations: The Apples Pears (closed) 3pts — The Kami 2pts — Winning Draw 1pt — The Favors 1pt — Trump (1 card) +1pt. Total: 8 points (+ recovery of the 1pt stake).

Combinations “Keys” and Points — “for Masters” Version

Starting Capital: 20 Points (2 × 5pts, 8 × 1pt, 4 × ½ pt).

Stacking rule

Each combination present in the winning hand earns a fixed number of points. These combinations can be stacked with one another. O/C: Open or Closed Hand. C: Closed Hand required. O: Open Hand required. All O/C combinations earn 1pt extra if achieved with a Closed Hand, with the exception of the Stream and the Favors. Stacking exception: The Small Path and the Long Path never stack together. Likewise, The Apples Pears and the Hearts/Silver/Earth Hands never stack with each other.

Winning Draw — 1pt · Closed Hand required [CASUAL] Draw the winning card.	The Favors — 1pt · Open or Closed Hand [CASUAL] A Triplet of Queens / or a Triplet of the Turn Jack (same suit as the Trump) / or a Triplet of your Position. (All stack together.) No Bonus for Closed Hand.
The Stream — 1pt · Open or Closed Hand [CASUAL] A hand made up only of cards from 2 to 8. No Bonus for Closed Hand. ex: 2 3 4 4 5 6 5 6 7 2 2	The Small Path — 1pt · Open or Closed Hand [CASUAL] A Run in two identical copies. ex: 1 2 3 1 2 3 4 4 4 J J
The Two Oaks — 1pt · Open or Closed Hand [CASUAL] The same Triplet in two suits. ex: 3 3 3 3 3 3 4 4 4 J J	The Kami — 2pts · Closed Hand required [CASUAL] Declare “Kami” by staking 1pt (the hand must be Waiting). Kami may be declared only if, at that moment, at least one of the awaited cards is absent from all discard piles.
The Oak Grove — 2pts · Open Hand required [CASUAL] Only Triplets. (Open Hand required.)	The River — 1pt · Closed Hand required [INITIATES] Runs only, double wait, ordinary pair. ex: with 2 3 in hand, either 1 or 4 can complete the Run
The Two Maples — 2pts · Open or Closed Hand [INITIATES] Two Concealed Triplets (the rest of the hand may be open).	Left Bank Right Bank — 2pts · Open or Closed Hand [INITIATES] Every element of the hand contains Terminals or Honors. ex: 1 2 3 7 8 9 Q Q Q 9 9
The 5 Pairs — 3pts · Closed Hand required [INITIATES] 5 pairs + one card identical to a card in one of the Pairs. ex: 1 1 J J 5 5 9 9 6 6 5	The Apples Pears — 2pts · Open or Closed Hand [CHAMPIONS] A single suit plus Honors. ex: 1 2 3 9 9 9 Q Q Q 8 8
The Prestige — 3pts · Open or Closed Hand [CHAMPIONS] Only Terminals or Honors. ex: 1 1 1 9 9 9 J J J Q Q	The Winding Path — 3pts · Open or Closed Hand [CHAMPIONS] The same Run in three suits. ex: 1 2 3 1 2 3 1 2 3 4 4
The Long Path — 3pts · Open or Closed Hand [CHAMPIONS] A Run in two identical copies + the same Run in another suit. ex: 1 2 3 1 2 3 1 2 3 4 4	The Great Road — 3pts · Open or Closed Hand [CHAMPIONS] 123456789 in a single suit + any pair.

The Small Jack — 4pts · Open or Closed Hand [MASTERS] Two Triplets of Jacks + a pair of the third.	The Small Queen — 4pts · Open or Closed Hand [MASTERS] Two Triplets of Queens + a pair of the third.
— GRAND KEYS —	
The Maple Grove — 6pts · Closed Hand required [MASTERS] Three Concealed Triplets.	The Hearts Hand — 5pts · Open or Closed Hand [MASTERS] A hand made only of cards from the Hearts suit (no Honors).
The Silver Hand — 5pts · Open or Closed Hand [MASTERS] A hand made only of cards from the Diamonds suit (no Honors).	The Earth Hand — 5pts · Open or Closed Hand [MASTERS] A hand made only of cards from the Clubs suit (no Honors).
The Grand Queen — 10pts · Open or Closed Hand [MASTERS] A Triplet of each Queen.	The Grand Jack — 10pts · Open or Closed Hand [MASTERS] A Triplet of each Jack.
The Grand Prestige — 10pts · Open or Closed Hand [MASTERS] Only Terminals. ex: 1♥1♥1♥9♦9♦9♦9♥9♥9♥1♣1♣	The Court — 10pts · Open or Closed Hand [MASTERS] Only Honors. ex: Q♣Q♣Q♣J♥J♥J♥J♦J♦J♦Q♥Q♥
The Council of Sages — 10pts · Closed Hand required [MASTERS] Ten different cards among the 12 Terminals/Honors + one Double. ex: Q♥J♥1♦9♦1♣9♣Q♣J♣1♥9♥Q♥	Kamiwaza 神業 — 15pts · Open or Closed Hand [MASTERS] Cards from a single suit (including Honors) with the following cards: 1♣2♣3♣4♣5♣6♣7♣8♣9♣J♣Q♣
Kami no Kumon 神の九門 — 15pts · Open or Closed Hand [MASTERS] Cards from a single suit with the following cards: 1♥1♥2♥3♥4♥5♥6♥7♥8♥9♥9♥	

+1pt per Trump card present in the hand. • +1pt per Under Trump card present in the hand — only on a Kami victory.

Examples

Example 1 — One combination

Hand: 2♥3♥4♥ / 5♥6♥7♥ / 8♥8♥8♥ / 9♥9♥ — Victory by Capture (“Thank you!”).
Combination: The Hearts Hand (only Hearts, no Honors) — 5pts. Total: 5 points.

Example 2 — Two combinations (with Kami)

Waiting hand: 1♣2♣3♣ / 7♦8♦9♦ / 3♥3♥3♥ / 5♣ (waiting on the second 5♣). The player stakes 1pt and declares “Kami”, then draws the missing 5♣: “Served!”
Combinations: The Kami 2pts — Winning Draw 1pt. Total: 3 points (+ recovery of the 1pt stake).

Example 3 — Three combinations (with Kami)

Waiting hand: 3♥3♥3♥ / 7♦7♦7♦ / 2♣3♣4♣ / 9♣ (waiting on the second 9♣) — the entire hand was built by drawing, with no capture: both Triplets are Concealed. The player stakes 1pt and declares “Kami”, then draws the missing 9♣: “Served!”
Combinations: The Two Maples (closed) 3pts — The Kami 2pts — Winning Draw 1pt. Total: 6 points (+ recovery of the 1pt stake).

Example 4 — With Trump

Same hand as Example 3, but the Trump Indicator = 2♥ → the Trump is 3♥. The hand contains three 3♥ (the first Triplet). Combinations: The Two Maples (closed) 3pts — The Kami 2pts — Winning Draw 1pt — Trump (3 cards) +3pts. Total: 9 points (+ recovery of the 1pt stake).

Two-Player Variant

Setup

Proceed as for the 4-player version; however, remove 30 cards face down to create the “Dead Leaf Pile.” Players sit facing each other. Players in the 2nd and 4th Position are always ghost players.

Randomly determine a first player. This player is considered to be in first position, and the other player in third position. Players swap positions after each round. All other rules remain unchanged.

However, after finishing their turn by discarding a card, the player whose turn it is draws one more card from the “Forest” and discards it onto the discard pile of the ghost player (in position 2 or 4) to their left. This card may be captured like any other discarded card.

- **In the event of a Victory by Draw (“Served!”), payment is made in the same way as in a four-player game. The two ghost players are treated as players for the purpose of splitting the payment; their share is paid by the Bank.**
- **In the event of a Victory by Capture (“Thank you!”), the usual rule remains unchanged: the player who discarded the winning card pays the full number of Points. If the winning card comes from a ghost player’s discard pile, the full number of Points is paid by the Bank.**
- **If the Round ends without either opponent completing their hand, and one of them is Waiting, the other must pay them one point. If both opponents are Waiting, no points are paid. Ghost players never receive points — they have no Hand at all, just a discard pile.**
- **Short Game: each player plays twice in First Position.**
- **Long Game: each player plays four times in First Position.**

Other Variants

The Exploding Queen

When a Queen Triplet is completed by Capture, immediately reveal a new “Trump Indicator” from the “Dead Leaf Pile.” There can therefore be up to 4 Trumps in play. If a player wins the Round by Kami, reveal as many Under Indicators as there are Trump Indicators.

The Quads

You may now form Quads, either by drawing or by capturing. If you form a Quad by drawing, you must lay it on the table — thereby opening your hand — for it to be considered a Quad (you are not obligated to do so). Although made up of 4 cards, a Quad is always considered a three-card element. Whether the Quad is formed by drawing or by capturing, you do not discard any card: your hand remains at 10 cards once the Quad is revealed. Thanks to your Quad, the next player then benefits from an extra draw from the “Dead Leaf Pile,” followed by a discard, before beginning their turn.

Each Quad grants you 2 extra points if you win the Round.

The Jokers

Preparation: remove one 5 of each suit before adding three Jokers to the deck. A Joker is considered to be a 5 of any suit. It can be captured as a 5 of any suit. A Joker can never be part of a Pair. Each Joker in your hand grants 1 extra point if you win the Round.

The Dry Stream

The “Stream” combination can now only be completed with a Closed Hand.

Appendix — Kami Quick Reference

A complete, cumulative list of every combination “Key,” for use at the table. Each higher version includes all combinations from the previous versions: CASUAL (5pts capital) → INITIATES (10pts) → CHAMPIONS (15pts) → MASTERS (20pts).

Remember

Two exceptions to stacking: The Apples Pears and the Hearts/Silver/Earth Hands never stack with each other. Likewise, The Small Path and The Long Path never stack together. O/C: Open or Closed Hand — C: Closed Hand required — O: Open Hand required. All O/C combinations earn 1pt extra if achieved with a Closed Hand, with the exception of The Stream and The Favors.

Key	Pts	Scope	Introduced
Winning Draw	1pt	C	CASUAL
The Favors	1pt	O/C	CASUAL
The Stream	1pt	O/C	CASUAL
The Small Path	1pt	O/C	CASUAL
The Two Oaks	1pt	O/C	CASUAL
The Kami	2pts	C	CASUAL
The Oak Grove	2pts	O	CASUAL
The River	1pt	C	INITIATES
The Two Maples	2pts	O/C	INITIATES
Left Bank Right Bank	2pts	O/C	INITIATES
The 5 Pairs	3pts	C	INITIATES
The Apples Pears	2pts	O/C	CHAMPIONS
The Prestige	3pts	O/C	CHAMPIONS
The Winding Path	3pts	O/C	CHAMPIONS
The Long Path	3pts	O/C	CHAMPIONS
The Great Road	3pts	O/C	CHAMPIONS
The Small Jack	4pts	O/C	MASTERS
The Small Queen	4pts	O/C	MASTERS
— GRAND KEYS —			
The Maple Grove	6pts	C	MASTERS
The Hearts Hand	5pts	O/C	MASTERS
The Silver Hand	5pts	O/C	MASTERS
The Earth Hand	5pts	O/C	MASTERS
The Grand Queen	10pts	O/C	MASTERS
The Grand Jack	10pts	O/C	MASTERS
The Grand Prestige	10pts	O/C	MASTERS
The Court	10pts	O/C	MASTERS
The Council of Sages	10pts	C	MASTERS
Kamiwaza 神業	15pts	O/C	MASTERS
Kami no Kumon 神の九門	15pts	O/C	MASTERS

+1pt per Trump card present in the hand. • +1pt per Under Trump card present in the hand — only on a Kami victory.

Kami — List of Keys

Each combination present in the winning hand earns a fixed number of points. These combinations can be stacked with one another.

Two exceptions to stacking: The Apples Pears and the Hearts/Silver/Earth Hands never stack with each other. Likewise, the Small Path and the Long Path never stack either.

O/C: Open or Closed Hand. C: Closed Hand Required. O: Open Hand Required. All O/C combinations earn 1pt extra if achieved with a Closed Hand, with the exception of the Stream and the Favors.

Version each combination is introduced in: CASUAL (5pts) · INITIATES (10pts) · CHAMPIONS (15pts) · MASTERS (20pts) — each higher version includes all combinations from the previous versions. · Grand Keys: from The Maple Grove to Kami no Kumon.

Winning Draw — 1pt · C
[CASUAL]

Draw the winning card.

The Favors — 1pt · O/C
[CASUAL]

A Triplet of Queens / or a Triplet of the Turn Jack (same suit as the Trump) / or a Triplet of your Position. (All stack together.) No Bonus for Closed Hand.

The Stream — 1pt · O/C
[CASUAL]

A hand made up only of cards from 2 to 8. No Bonus for Closed Hand.

ex: 2♦3♦4♦4♣5♣6♣
5♦6♦7♦2♥2♥

The River — 1pt · C
[INITIATES]

Runs only, double wait, ordinary pair.

ex: with 2♥3♥ in hand, either 1♥ or 4♥ can complete the Run

The Small Path — 1pt · O/C
[CASUAL]

A Run in two identical copies.

ex: 1♥2♥3♥1♥2♥3♥
4♦4♦4♦J♣J♣

The Two Oaks — 1pt · O/C
[CASUAL]

The same Triplet in two suits.

ex: 3♥3♥3♥3♣3♣3♣
4♦4♦4♦J♣J♣

The Kami — 2pts · C [CASUAL]
Declare “Kami” by staking 1pt (the hand must be Waiting). Kami may be declared only if, at that moment, at least one of the awaited cards is absent from all discard piles.

The Oak Grove — 2pts · O
[CASUAL]
Only Triplets. (Open Hand required.)

The Two Maples — 2pts · O/C
[INITIATES]

Two Concealed Triplets (the rest of the hand may be open).

Left Bank Right Bank — 2pts · O/C [INITIATES]

Every element of the hand contains Terminals or Honors.

ex: 1♥2♥3♥7♣8♣9♣
Q♥Q♥Q♥9♣9♣

The Apples Pears — 2pts · O/C
[CHAMPIONS]

A single suit plus Honors.

ex: 1♥2♥3♥9♥9♥9♥
Q♦Q♦Q♦8♥8♥

The 5 Pairs — 3pts · C
[INITIATES]

5 pairs + one card identical to a card in one of the Pairs.

ex: 1♥1♥J♣J♣5♣5♣
9♦9♦6♥6♥5♣

The Prestige — 3pts · O/C
[CHAMPIONS]

Only Terminals or Honors.

ex: 1♦1♦1♦9♣9♣9♣
J♦J♦J♦Q♥Q♥

The Winding Path — 3pts · O/C
[CHAMPIONS]

The same Run in three suits.

ex: 1♥2♥3♥1♣2♣3♣
1♦2♦3♦4♣4♣

The Long Path — 3pts · O/C
[CHAMPIONS]

A Run in two identical copies + the same Run in another suit.

ex: 1♥2♥3♥1♥2♥3♥
1♣2♣3♣4♣4♣

The Great Road — 3pts · O/C
[CHAMPIONS]

123456789 in a single suit + any pair.

The Small Jack — 4pts · O/C
[MASTERS]

Two Triplets of Jacks + a pair of the third.

The Small Queen — 4pts · O/C
[MASTERS]

Two Triplets of Queens + a pair of the third.

— GRAND KEYS —

The Maple Grove — 6pts · C
[MASTERS]

Three Concealed Triplets.

The Hearts Hand — 5pts · O/C
[MASTERS]

A hand made only of cards from the Hearts suit (no Honors).

The Silver Hand — 5pts · O/C
[MASTERS]

A hand made only of cards from the Diamonds suit (no Honors).

The Earth Hand — 5pts · O/C
[MASTERS]

A hand made only of cards from the Clubs suit (no Honors).

The Grand Queen — 10pts · O/C
[MASTERS]

A Triplet of each Queen.

The Grand Jack — 10pts · O/C
[MASTERS]

A Triplet of each Jack.

The Grand Prestige — 10pts · O/C [MASTERS]

Only Terminals.

ex: 1♥1♥1♥9♦9♦9♦
9♥9♥9♥1♣1♣

The Court — 10pts · O/C
[MASTERS]

Only Honors.

ex: Q♣Q♣Q♣J♥J♥J♥
J♦J♦J♦Q♥Q♥

The Council of Sages — 10pts · C [MASTERS]

Ten different cards among the 12 Terminals/Honors + one Double.

ex:
Q♥J♥1♦9♦1♣9♣Q♣J♣1♥9♥Q♥

Kamiwaza 神業 — 15pts · O/C
[MASTERS]

Cards from a single suit (including Honors) with the following cards:

1♣2♣3♣4♣5♣6♣7♣8♣9♣J♣Q♣

Kami no Kumon 神の九門 — 15pts · O/C [MASTERS]

Cards from a single suit with the following cards:

1♥1♥2♥3♥4♥5♥6♥7♥8♥9♥9♥

+1pt Trump, per Trump card present in the hand. • +1pt Under Trump per card present in the hand — only on a Kami victory.